



Title of the project

“Study of Investment in Stock Market by College Students”

Name of Academic Course and Academic year details

Second Year of B.com (Accounting and Finance) 2025-26

Sr. No.	Name	Roll No
1	Bhuvaneshwari Samy Durai	FF124023
2	Janhvi Santosh Gade	FF124024
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4	Chaitanya Sharad Gaonkar	FF124026
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Under the Guidance of

Mr. Mukul Kulkarni

Name of the Department/College/Institute

The SIA College of Higher Education (Autonomous)

Dombivli (East)

Academic Year 2025-26

THE SIA COLLEGE OF HIGHER EDUCATION(Autonomous)

Affiliated to University of Mumbai

Re-Accredited “B+” Grade



Certificate

I Hereby certify that Ms. Bhuvaneshwari Samy Durai , Roll no. FF124023, Student of The SIA College Of Higher Education (Autonomous) Institute Studying in Second Year of Accounting & Finance , has completed a Project titled “A Study of Investment in Stock Market by College Students” in the area of Bachelor’s in Accounting and Finance specialization for the academic year 2025-26. To The best of my knowledge the work of the student is original and the information included in the project is correct.

Internal Guide

Head of the Department

Principal

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Certificate

I Hereby certify that Ms. Janhvi Santosh Gade , Roll no. FF124024, Student of The SIA College Of Higher Education (Autonomous) Institute Studying in Second Year of Accounting & Finance , has completed a Project titled “A Study of Investment in Stock Market by College Students” in the area of Bachelor’s in Accounting and Finance specialization for the academic year 2025-26. To The best of my knowledge the work of the student is original and the information included in the project is correct.

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Certificate

I Hereby certify that Ms. Vaishnavi Jagan Gade , Roll no. FF124025, Student of The SIA College Of Higher Education (Autonomous) Institute Studying in Second Year of Accounting & Finance , has completed a Project titled “A Study of Investment in Stock Market by College Students” in the area of Bachelor’s in Accounting and Finance specialization for the academic year 2025-26. To The best of my knowledge the work of the student is original and the information included in the project is correct.

Internal Guide

Head of the Department

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Certificate

I Hereby certify that Mr. Chaitanya Sharad Gaonkar , Roll no. FF124026, Student of The SIA College Of Higher Education (Autonomous) Institute Studying in Second Year of Accounting & Finance , has completed a Project titled “A Study of Investment in Stock Market by College Students” in the area of Bachelor’s in Accounting and Finance specialization for the academic year 2025-26. To The best of my knowledge the work of the student is original and the information included in the project is correct.

Internal Guide

Head of the Department

Principal

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Certificate

I Hereby certify that Ms. Disha Pradeep Gaonkar , Roll no. FF124027, Student of The SIA College Of Higher Education (Autonomous) Institute Studying in Second Year of Accounting & Finance , has completed a Project titled “A Study of Investment in Stock Market by College Students” in the area of Bachelor’s in Accounting and Finance specialization for the academic year 2025-26. To The best of my knowledge the work of the student is original and the information included in the project is correct.

Internal Guide

Head of the Department

Principal

Declaration

I, Mr./Ms. Bhuvaneshwari Samy Durai, Janhvi Santosh Gade, Vaishnavi Jagan Gade, Chaitanya Sharad Gaonkar, Disha Pradeep Gaonkar Student of The SIA College Of Higher Education (Autonomous) Institute studying in Second year of Accounting & Finance, hereby declare that I have completed the Field Project entitled A Study of Investment in Stock Market by College Students during the academic year 2025-26.

The report work is original and the information/data included in the report is true emerging from the primary and secondary data gathered and analysed as a part of this project.

Due credit is extended on the work of Literature/Secondary Survey by endorsing it in the Biography as per prescribed format.

Name of the student	Signature
Bhuvaneshwari Samy Durai	
Janhvi Santosh Gade	
Vaishnavi Jagan Gade	
Chaitanya Sharad Gaonkar	
Disha Pradeep Gaonkar	

Acknowledement

I am thankful to the Assistant Professor MR. **MUKUL KULKARNI** for his valuable guidance in successful completion of this project.

My overriding debt due to our Principal **DR. PADMAJA ARVIND** and librarian **MRS. BHARATI RAO**.

Last but not the least I cannot forget my friends and my parents whose constant encouragement and support made this task a happy job.

Name of the student	Signature
Bhuvaneshwari Samy Durai	
Janhvi Santosh Gade	
Vaishnavi Jagan Gade	
Chaitanya Sharad Gaonkar	
Disha Pradeep Gaonkar	

(SECOND YEAR BACHELOR OF COMMERCE)

(ACCOUNTING AND FINANCE)

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Abstract



The research paper titled “Study of Investment in Stock Market by College Students” explores the growing interest and participation of young adults, especially college students, in the stock market. The study emphasizes how the stock market acts as a vital component of economic development by providing a platform for companies to raise capital and for individuals to generate wealth through investments. It also highlights the importance of financial literacy among youth, noting that early exposure to investment practices can help shape responsible financial behavior.

Purpose and Objectives

The primary objective of this study is to understand the investment behavior, preferences, and patterns of college students in the stock market. It seeks to identify the factors influencing their investment decisions, such as knowledge level, risk appetite, family background, and motivation. Additionally, the research examines the challenges faced by students, such as lack of guidance, limited financial education, and fear of loss. The study also aims to assess their awareness of taxation on returns and their satisfaction with investment outcomes. By doing so, it hopes to provide valuable insights into how financial awareness can be improved among the youth.

Literature Review

The review of previous studies reveals that financial literacy, demographic factors, and educational background strongly influence investment behavior among young people. Research by Geetha & Ramesh (2012) and Kumari & Sar (2017) indicates that finance students are generally more aware and confident in stock market investments compared to others. Studies by Sivaramakrishnan & Srivastava (2019) and Chavali & Mohanraj (2020) further establish that financial education and exposure to finance-related subjects enhance confidence and participation in the market. These findings support the idea that integrating financial education into academic curricula can significantly benefit students’ investment understanding.

Methodology

The study is based on both primary and secondary data. Primary data was collected through a structured questionnaire distributed among college students, while secondary data was gathered from books, journals, research papers, and online resources. A total of 57 students participated in the survey. The questions covered various aspects, including awareness, investment habits, preferred modes of investment, motivations, challenges, and satisfaction levels. The collected data was analyzed and interpreted using percentages and tables.

Key Findings

- **Demographics:** The majority of respondents (84.2%) were aged between 15 and 20 years, representing young and early-stage investors. Most were BAF (Bachelor of Accounting and Finance) students.
- **Awareness and Knowledge:** Around 84.2% of students were aware of the stock market, but 68.4% considered themselves beginners, indicating a gap between awareness and practical understanding.
- **Sources of Knowledge:** Social media and YouTube (59.6%) were the most common sources of learning, followed by family, friends, and college teachers. This shows the increasing influence of digital platforms in financial education.
- **Investment Participation:** 61.4% of respondents had already invested in the stock market, mainly through Mutual Funds (SIPs), which were preferred by 66% of participants. Direct stock investments were less common (15.1%).
- **Investment Motivation:** The main reasons for investing included gaining knowledge and experience (35.7%), earning extra income (33.9%), and creating long-term wealth (29.8%).
- **Investment Amounts:** Most students invested small amounts — 26.3% invested less than ₹1000, and 17.5% between ₹1000–₹5000. About 43.9% had not yet made any investments.
- **Risk Appetite:** A majority (56.1%) had medium risk-taking capacity, while 33.3% were risk-averse. Only 10.5% showed high risk tolerance.
- **Challenges:** The biggest challenge faced by students was fear of loss (46.4%), followed by lack of proper guidance (39.3%) and market volatility (39.3%).

- Sources of Income: Most students relied on family support (36.8%) and pocket money (24.6%) to fund their investments, showing limited financial independence.
- Tax Knowledge and Satisfaction: 58.9% of respondents had some awareness of taxes on returns, but satisfaction levels with returns were mixed — over half (55.4%) were neutral, showing that expectations and results often differ.
- Need for Education: A large majority (86%) of respondents agreed that stock market education should be included in college syllabuses, emphasizing the demand for practical financial literacy.

Interpretation

The study concludes that while college students show strong enthusiasm and growing participation in the stock market, their financial knowledge and practical experience remain limited. Most are beginners who depend on digital media or informal advice rather than structured education. Mutual Funds are the preferred investment choice due to their lower risk compared to direct stock trading. Despite challenges like lack of guidance and fear of loss, students view investing as an opportunity to gain knowledge and financial discipline.

The findings highlight the urgent need to integrate stock market and financial literacy education into college curricula. By doing so, institutions can prepare students to make informed and responsible financial decisions in the future. The research also suggests that policymakers, educators, and financial organizations should collaborate to design training programs, workshops, and simulation platforms to build financial awareness and confidence among young investors.

Ultimately, this study reinforces the belief that early investment exposure can play a vital role in shaping future financial behavior, promoting a culture of informed investing, and contributing to the nation's economic growth.

Chapter I

Introduction



The stock market plays a crucial role in the economic development of any country. It serves as a platform where companies can raise capital by issuing shares, and investors have the opportunity to buy and sell these shares to earn returns. Investing in the stock market not only helps in wealth creation but also teaches valuable lessons in financial management, risk assessment, and decision-making. Over the past few decades, the importance of financial literacy among young adults has increased significantly. College students, being young and energetic, represent a segment that can greatly benefit from early investment practices, shaping their financial habits and understanding of the market.

In recent years, there has been a growing interest among college students in participating in the stock market. Several factors contribute to this trend, including easy access to online trading platforms, social media awareness, and increasing knowledge of investment opportunities. Despite being relatively inexperienced, students are motivated by the potential to earn profits, learn about financial management, and gain practical exposure to real-world economics. However, investing without proper knowledge can be risky, as the stock market is highly volatile and influenced by multiple economic, political, and social factors.

The objective of this study is to explore the investment patterns, preferences, and behavior of college students in the stock market. The study aims to understand the factors influencing their investment decisions, the level of risk they are willing to take, and the types of securities they prefer to invest in, such as equity shares, mutual funds, or derivatives. It also seeks to identify the challenges faced by students, such as lack of knowledge, fear of losses, or dependence on advisors and social media trends. By examining these aspects, the study intends to highlight the level of financial awareness among young investors and provide suggestions to improve investment knowledge and practices.

Understanding the investment behavior of college students is important for multiple reasons. Firstly, it reflects the current trends and attitudes toward financial markets among the youth. Secondly, it can help educational institutions, policymakers, and financial organizations to

design targeted programs that encourage responsible investment and enhance financial literacy. Lastly, it provides insights into how early investment experiences can influence long-term financial planning and decision-making.

This research is based on a field study conducted among college students, using a combination of primary and secondary data. Primary data is collected through questionnaires and interviews to gather direct information about students' investment habits, motivations, and experiences. Secondary data is obtained from books, research papers, journals, and online resources to provide a theoretical background and support the findings. By analyzing this data, the study will present a clear picture of the investment trends among college students, highlighting both opportunities and challenges in this domain.

In conclusion, the study of investment in the stock market by college students is not only academically significant but also socially relevant. It helps in understanding the financial mindset of young investors, identifies gaps in knowledge and awareness, and suggests practical measures to enhance their investment skills. This research contributes to the broader understanding of youth participation in financial markets and can serve as a foundation for further studies on financial literacy, risk management, and investment behavior among young adults.

Chapter II

Literature Reviews



1. Geetha, N., & Ramesh, M. (2012) – “A Study on People’s Preferences in Investment Behaviour”

This study highlights that young investors, especially college students, are more attracted to stock market investments compared to traditional options like bank deposits.

It shows that awareness, risk appetite, and financial literacy strongly affect student investment decisions.

2. Kumari, S., & Sar (2017) - “Investment Awareness among Youth: A Study with Special Reference to Students”

The study found that most students have low awareness of stock markets and prefer safe investments.

However, finance students showed higher interest and knowledge compared to other disciplines.

3. Sivaramakrishnan, S., & Srivastava, M. (2019) – “The Relationship between Financial Literacy, Investment Attitude, and Investment Decisions among Young Adults”

Explores how financial literacy directly influences stock market participation among college students.

Students with better financial education programs showed higher confidence in stock market investments.

4. Chavali, K., & Mohanraj, K. (2020) – “Impact of Demographic Factors on Investment Decisions of Young Investors”

Focuses on college students and early career youth.

Results showed that age, education, and family income play a significant role in shaping investment preferences.

Students with higher exposure to finance education invested more in stocks.

Chapter III

Methodology



1. Research Approach

The study adopts a descriptive research approach as it seeks to understand and measure customer satisfaction levels in the banking sector. The focus is on identifying service quality parameters such as efficiency, staff behavior, digital services, grievance handling, and overall satisfaction. A structured survey was chosen as the primary tool to capture quantitative data supported by qualitative insights.

2. Data Collection Methods

To ensure accuracy and comprehensiveness, multiple methods were used for data collection during the field visit:

Questionnaire/Survey Method

A structured questionnaire with both close-ended (Likert scale, multiple choice) and a few open-ended questions was designed.

This helped in quantifying customer responses while also allowing them to express their views in detail. The survey was administered both physically at bank branches and digitally through Google Forms.

Observational Method

Non intrusive observation was conducted at selected bank branches to assess customer flow, waiting time, staff-customer interactions, and service delivery environment.

This provided real-time evidence of service quality and efficiency.

Chapter IV

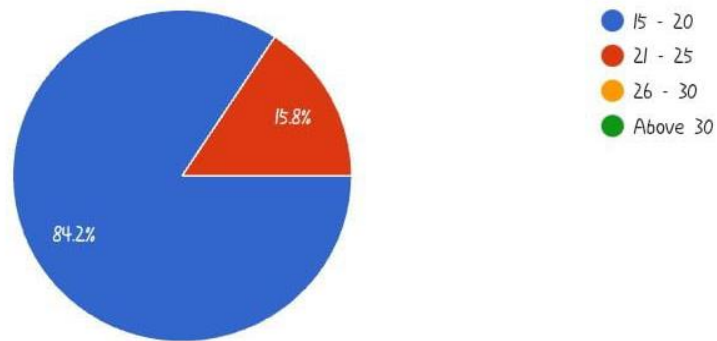
Field Work Description, Observations & Analysis



Age

RESPONSES	RESPONDENT	PERCENTAGE
15-20	48	84.2%
21-25	9	15.8%
26-30	Nil	Nil
Above 30	Nil	Nil

57 responses

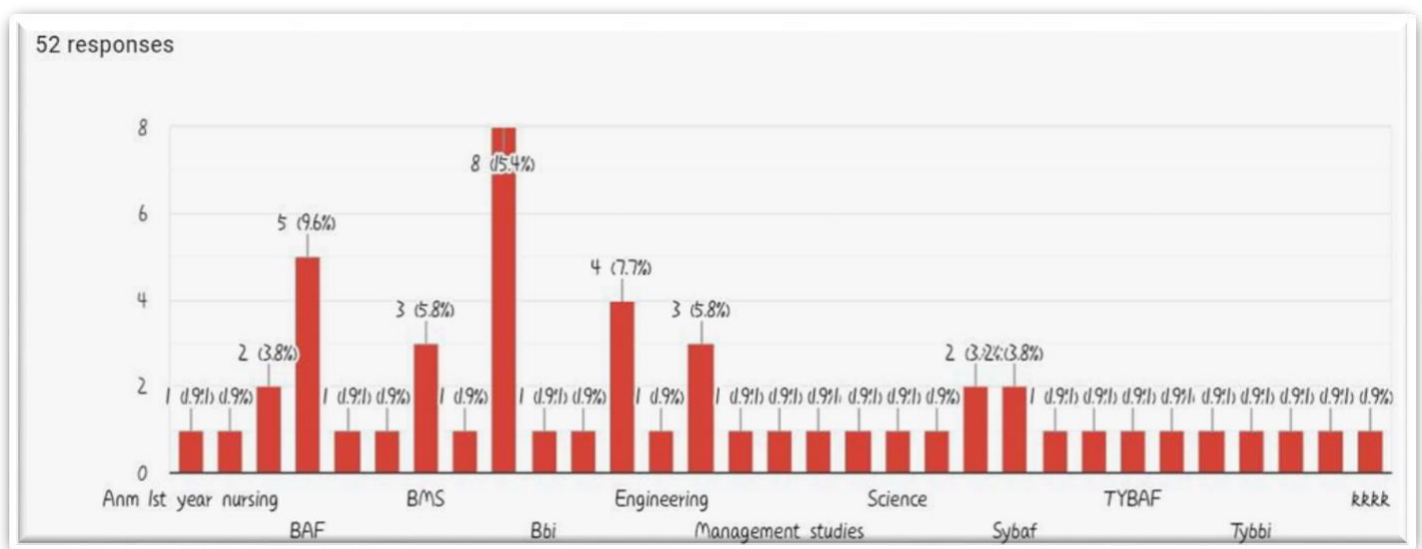


Interpretation:

The vast majority of the 57 respondents (84.2%) are in the 15-20 age group, with the remaining 15.8% in the 21-25 age group, and no respondents above 25.

Course of Study

RESPONSES	RESPONDENT	PERCENTAGE
BAF	27	51.92%
BMS	7	13.46%
B.Com	6	11.54%
Commerce	6	11.54%
Others	6	11.54%

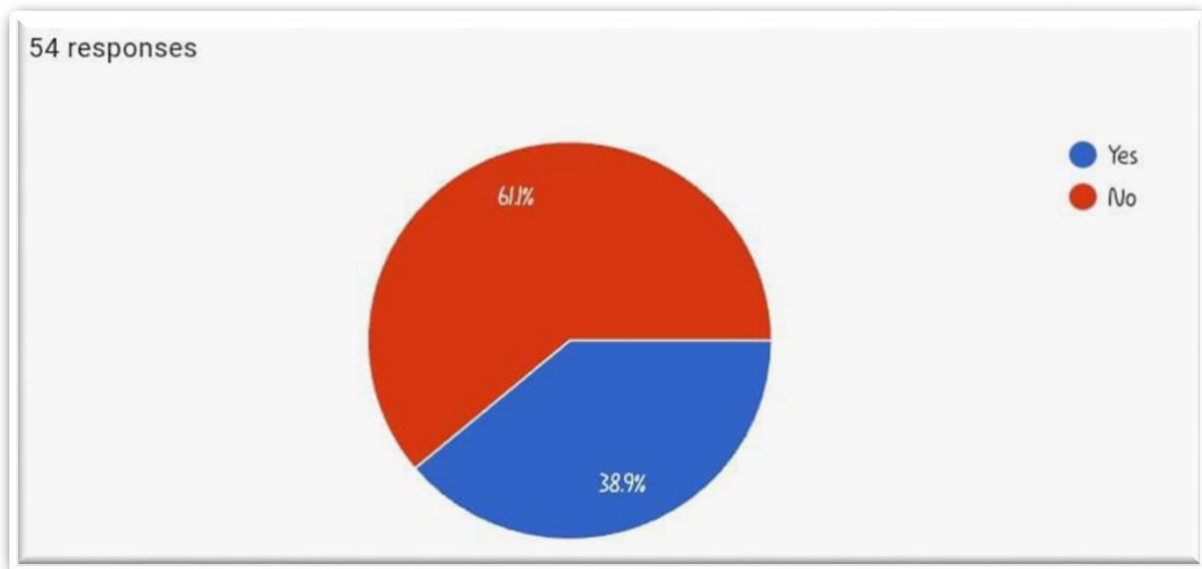


Interpretation:

The table shows that BAF is the most popular course of study among the respondents, accounting for over half of all responses.

1. Do you have any family background in finance and business?

RESPONSES	RESPONDENT	PERCENTAGE
Yes	21	38.9%
no	33	61.1%

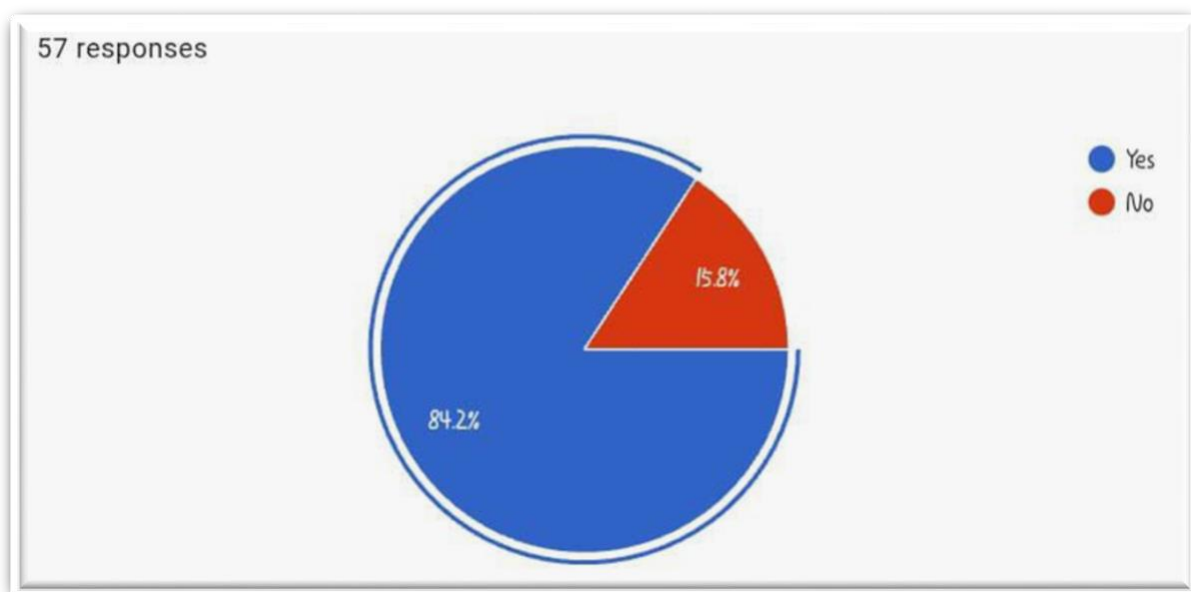


Interpretation:

The graph indicates that a majority of the respondents, specifically 61.1% (33 out of 54 respondents), do not have a family background in finance and business, while 38.9% (21 out of 54 respondents) do. This suggests that in the surveyed group, individuals without a family background in these fields are more prevalent.

2. Are you aware of the stock market?

RESPONSES	RESPONDENT	PERCENTAGE
YES	48	84.2%
NO	9	15.8%

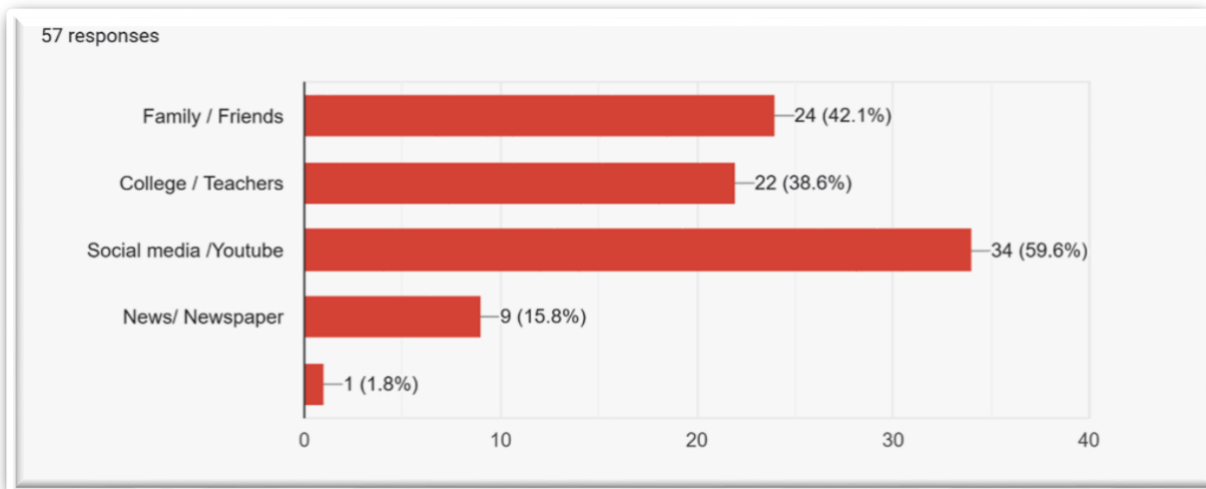


Interpretation:

The interpretation of the data is that the majority of respondents (84.2% or 48 out of 57) are aware of the stock market, while a smaller portion (15.8% or 9 out of 57) are not.

3. What is your main source of stock market knowledge?

RESPONSES	RESPONDENT	PERCENTAGE
Family/ Friend	24	42.1%
College/ teacher	22	38.6%
Social media/ You tube	34	59.6%
News/ newspaper	9	15.8%
Other	1	1.8%

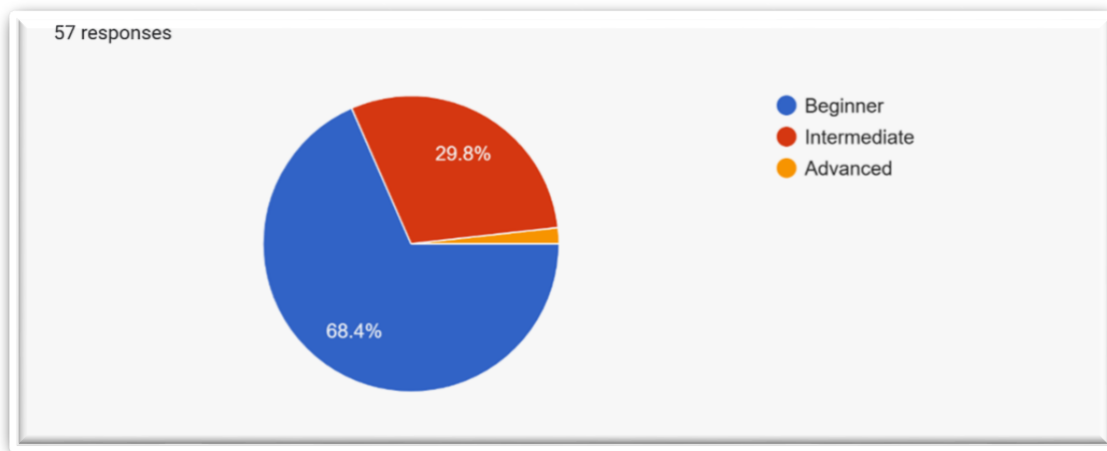


Interpretation:

The data indicates that social media/YouTube (59.6%) is the most common source of stock market knowledge among respondents, followed by family/friends (42.1%) and college/teachers (38.6%). Traditional sources like news/newspapers (15.8%) and "other" sources (1.8%) are much less frequently used.

4. .How would you rate your level of knowledge about stock market investment?

RESPONSES	RESPONDENT	PERCENTAGE
Beginner	39	68.4%
Intermediate	17	29.8%
Advanced	1	29.8%

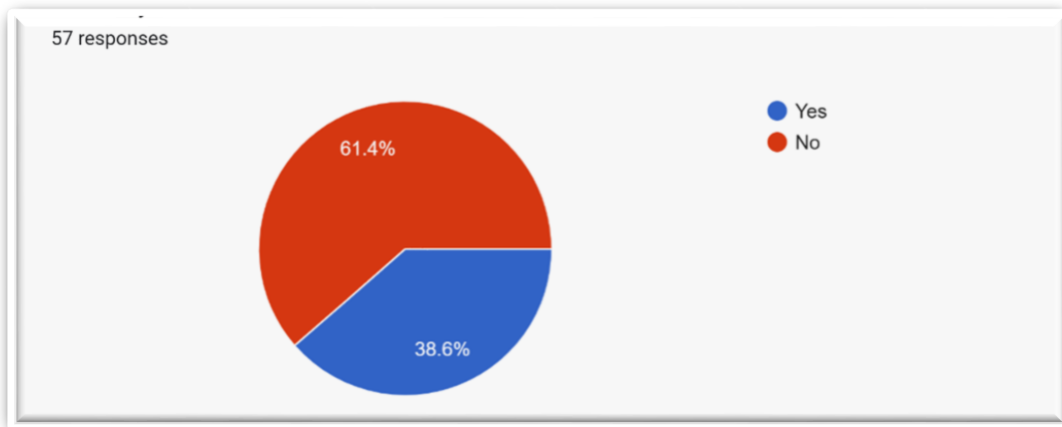


Interpretation:

A majority of respondents, 68.4%, classified themselves as beginners, while 29.8% identified as intermediate, and only 1 respondent (1.8%) claimed an advanced level of knowledge.

5. Have you ever invested in the stock market?

RESPONSES	RESPONDENT	PERCENTAGE
Yes	35	61.4%
No	22	38.6%

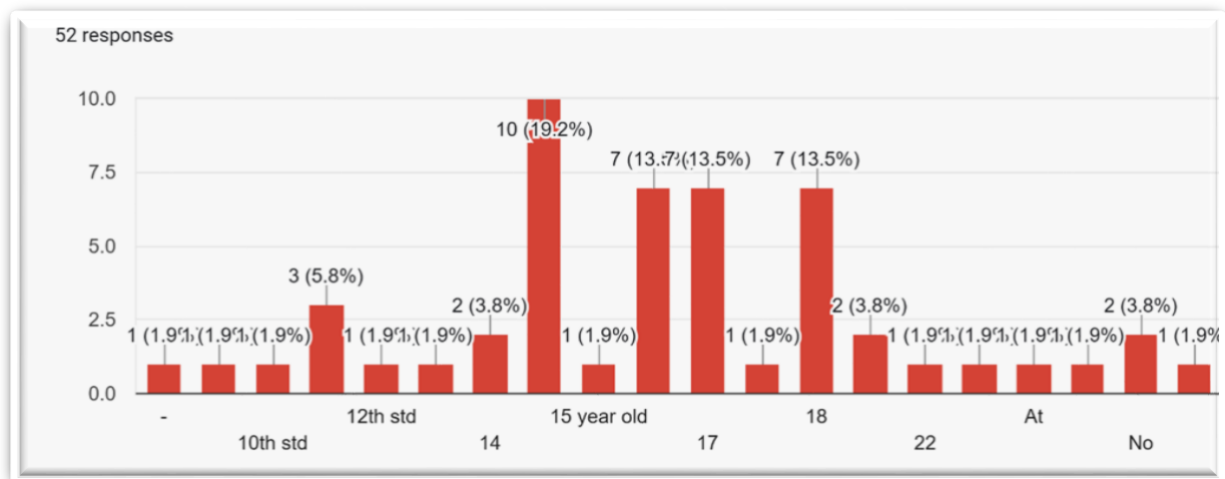


Interpretation:

The results show that 61.4% of respondents (35 out of 57) have invested in the stock market, while 38.6% (22 respondents) have not.

This finding is significant because it suggests that a majority of students are not only aware of stock markets but are also actively participating in investment activities.

6. At what age did you first hear about the stock the market?



Interpretation:

Responses are spread across a range of ages, but certain trends stand out:

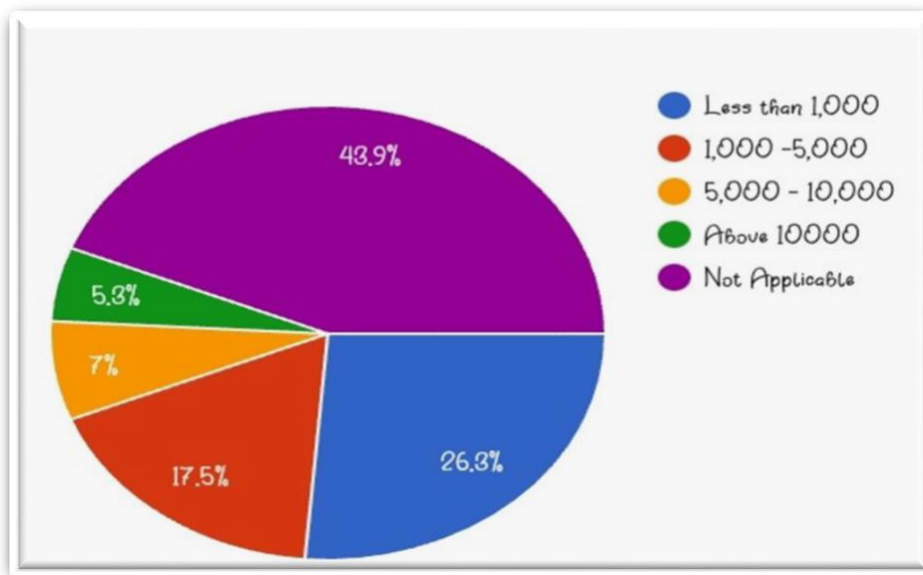
The most common age was 15 years old (19.2%), followed by 16 years (13.4%), 17 years (13.5%), and 18 years (13.5%).

A smaller percentage reported first hearing about the stock market in earlier school years (10th or 12th standard, around 1–5.8%), while very few indicated exposure after age 20.

7.How much (on Avg) do you invest in the market?

RESPONSES	RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
Less than 1000	15	26.30%
1000 - 5000	10	17.50%
5000 - 10000	4	7%
Above 10000	3	5.30%
Not Applicable	25	43.90%

57 responses



Interpretation :

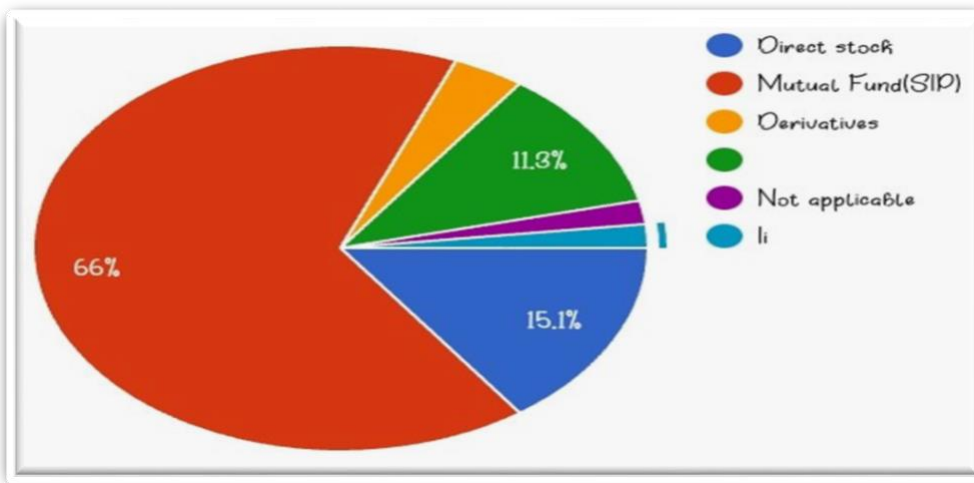
Most of the respondents (43.9%) do not invest in the market. Among those who do, the highest share (26.3%) invest less than 1000 annually. A smaller number (17.5%) invest between 1000–5000, while very few (7% and 5.3%) invest larger amounts above 5000.

Overall, investment levels are mostly low, and many people don't invest at all.

8.What mode of investment do you use?

RESPONSES	RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGES
Direct stock	8	15.10%
Mutual Funds (SIP)	35	66%
Derivatives	2	3.80%
Lic	1	1.90%
Other	6	11.30%
Not Applicable	1	1.90%

53 responses



Interpretation:

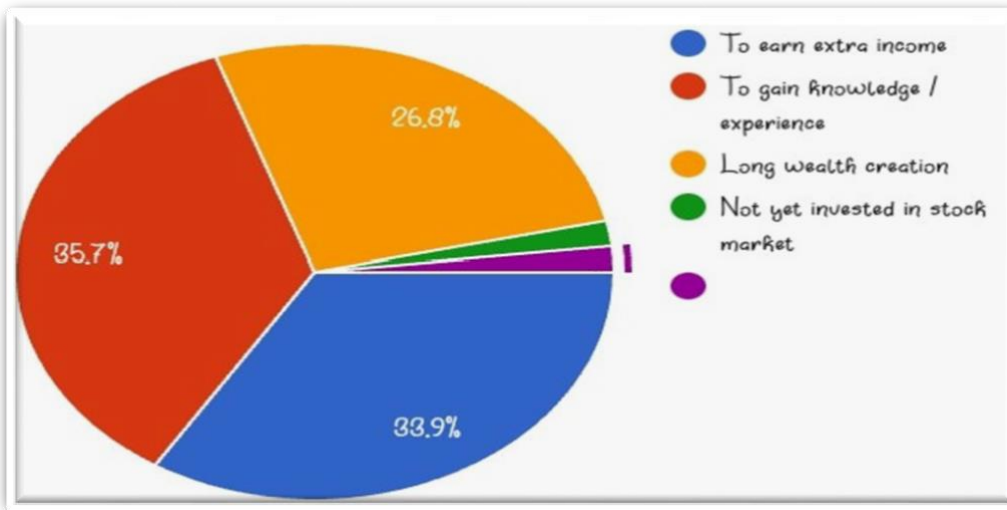
Most respondents (66%) prefer Mutual Funds (SIP) as their mode of investment. Direct stock is chosen by 15.1%, while demat/other services are used by only 3.8%. A small number prefer LIC (1.9%) or other options (11.3%), and 1.9% said it is not applicable.

Overall, Mutual Funds (SIP) are the most popular choice, while other modes of investment are much less common.

9. Do you plan to increase your investment in the stock market?

RESPONSES	RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
To earn extra income	19	33.90%
To gain knowledge / experience	20	35.70%
Not yet invested in stock	1	1.80%
Long wealth creation	15	29.80%
Other	1	1.80%

57 responses



Interpretation:

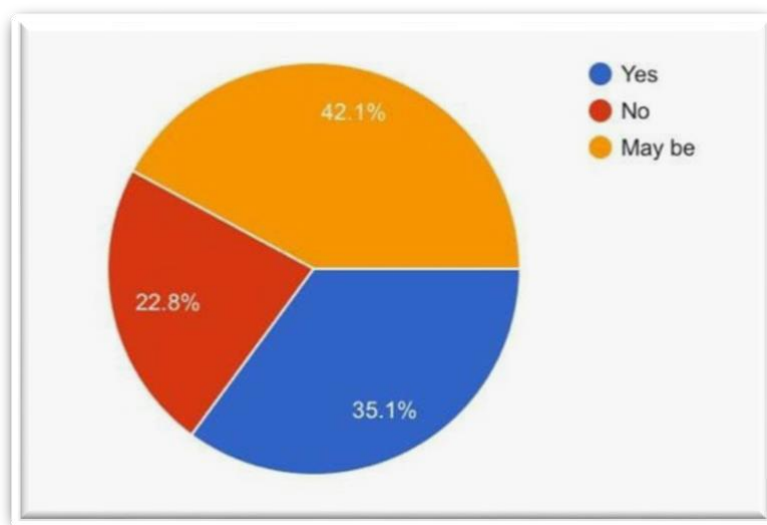
Most respondents are motivated to invest in stock to gain knowledge/experience (35.7%) and to earn extra income (33.9%). Another 26.8% invest for long-term wealth creation. Very few (1.8% each) said they have not yet invested or chose other reasons.

Overall, the main motivations are learning, extra income, and wealth creation, while very few have no investment experience.

10. Do you plan to increase your investment in the stock market?

RESPONSES	RESPONDENT	PERCENTAGE
Yes	20	35.1
No	13	22.8
Maybe	24	42.1

57 responses



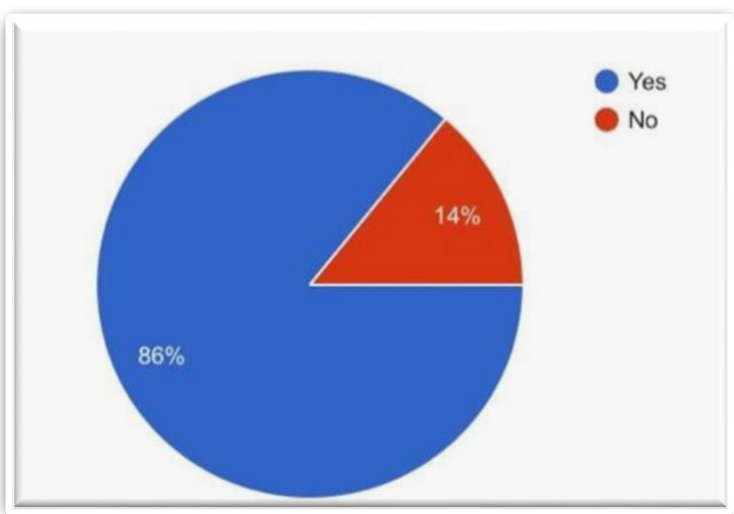
Interpretation:

Out of 57 respondents, 35.1% expressed a clear intention to increase their investments in the stock market, while 22.8% stated they do not plan to invest further. A significant portion, 42.1%, remain uncertain and responded with “maybe.” This indicates that although there is considerable interest in expanding investments, many individuals are still hesitant and undecided, possibly due to factors such as risk perception, lack of knowledge, or market uncertainty.

11. Do you think stock market education should be part of college curriculum (syllabus, studies, subjects)?

RESPONSES	RESPONDENT	PERCENTANGE
Yes	49	86
No	7	14

57 responses



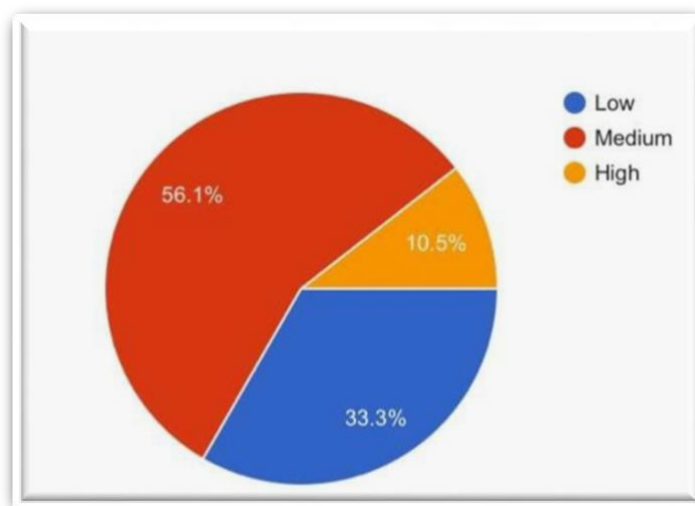
Interpretation:

11 Out of 57 respondents, a large majority (86%) believe that stock market education should be included as part of the college curriculum, while only 14% disagree. This shows strong support for integrating financial literacy and investment knowledge into academic studies, reflecting the growing awareness among students of the importance of practical financial education for future decision-making.

12.How do you consider your risk taking ability?

RESPONSES	RESPONDENT	PERCENTANGE
Low	19	33.3
Medium	32	56.1
High	6	10.5

57 responses



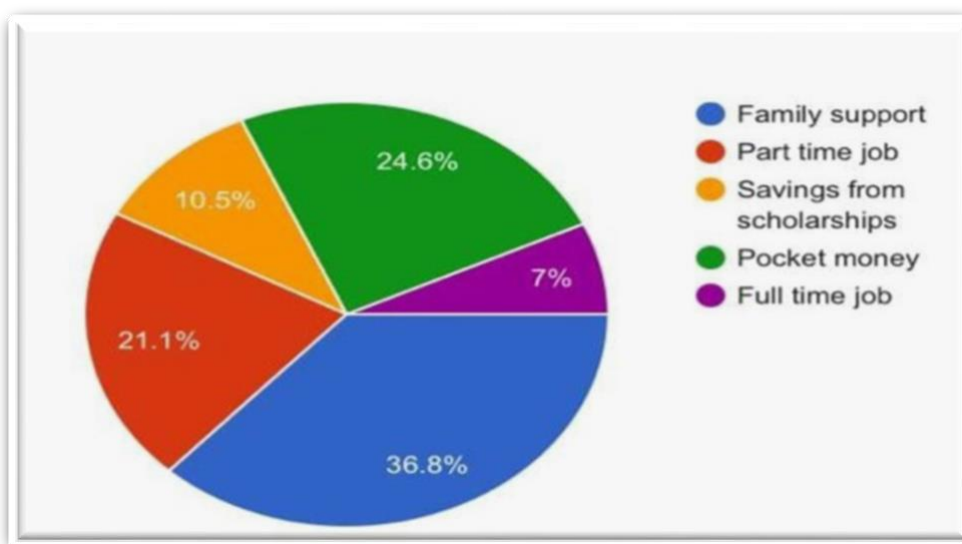
Interpretation:

The majority of the data falls into the Medium category, making up over half (56.1%) of the total. The Low category is the second most common at 33.3%, while the High category is the least represented, accounting for only 10.5%. This suggests that most values are concentrated in the medium range, with fewer instances of extreme highs.

13.What is your source of income for investment ?

RESPONSES	RESPONDENT	PERCENTANGE
Family support	21	36.8
Part time job	12	21.1
Saving from Scholarship	6	10.5
Pocket money	14	24.6
Full time job	4	7

57 responses

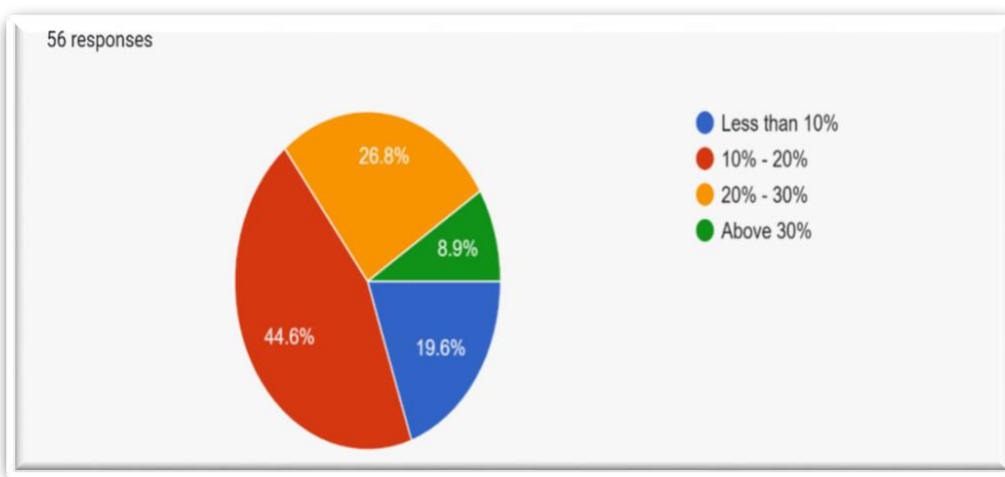


Interpretation :

From the survey analysis of 57 respondents, it is evident that the primary source of income for investment is family support (36.8%), followed by pocket money (24.6%) and part-time jobs (21.1%). A smaller proportion rely on savings from scholarships (10.5%) and full-time jobs (7%). This indicates that most respondents are still financially dependent on external sources, particularly family, rather than their own earnings. The data suggests that for many individuals, investment activities are initiated with limited personal income, highlighting a dependency on support systems rather than financial independence.

14. How much do you expect from stock market?

RESPONSES	RESPONDENT	PERCENTAGE
Less than 10%	12	21.1%
10%	25	43.9%
20%	15	26.3%
Above 30%	5	8.8%

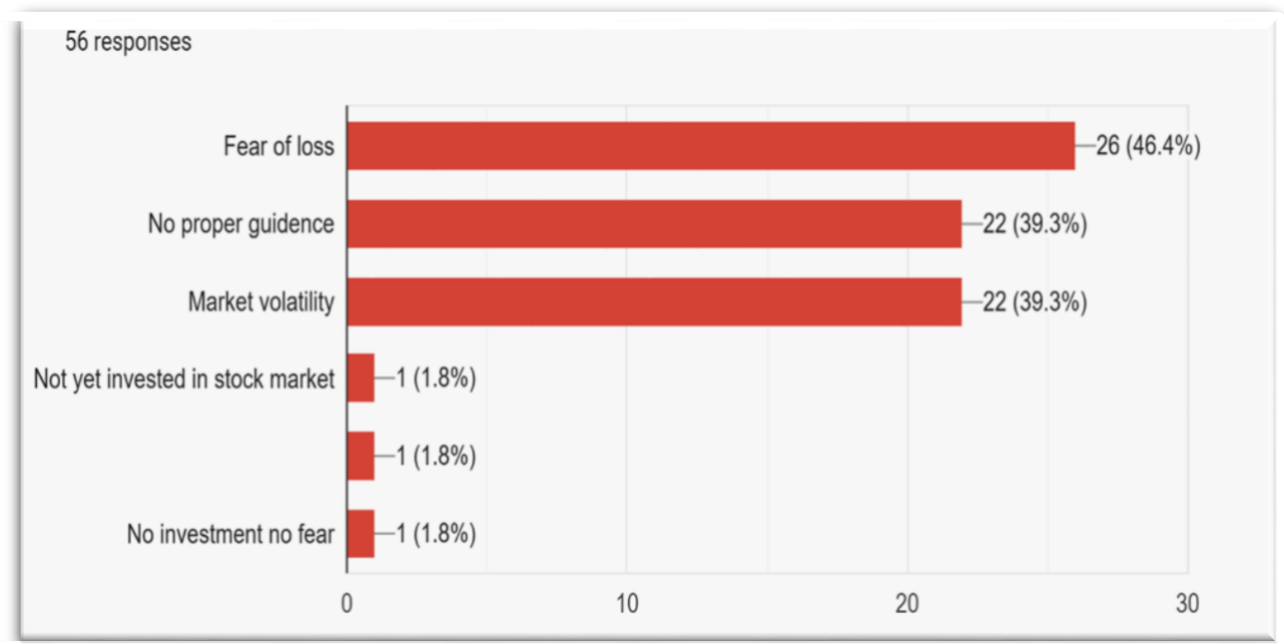


Interpretation :

The pie chart reveals that the largest proportion of respondents (44.6%) expect a return of "Above 30%" from the stock market, while the smallest group (8.9%) anticipates "20%-30%" returns. The remaining respondents are almost evenly split between expecting "Less than 10%" (26.8%) and "10%-20%" (19.6%) returns.

15. What challenges you face while investing ?

RESPONSES	RESPONDENT	PERCENTAGE
Fear of loss	26	46.4%
No proper Guidance	22	39.3%
Market volatility	22	39.3%
Not yet invested in stock market	1	1.8%
No investment no fear	1	1.8%

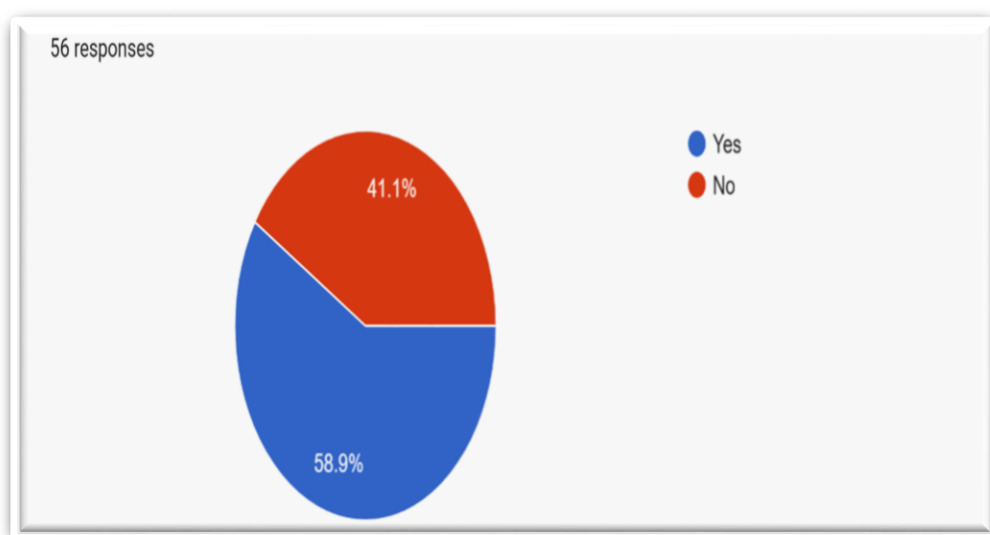


Interpretation :

The bar graph reveals that "Fear of loss" is the most significant challenge faced by individuals while investing (46.4%). Following this, "No proper guidance" and "Market volatility" are the next most common challenges, both cited by 39.3% of respondents.

16. Do you knowledge about tax on returns ?

RESPONSES	RESPONDENT	PERCENTAGE
YES	33	58.9%
NO	23	41.1%

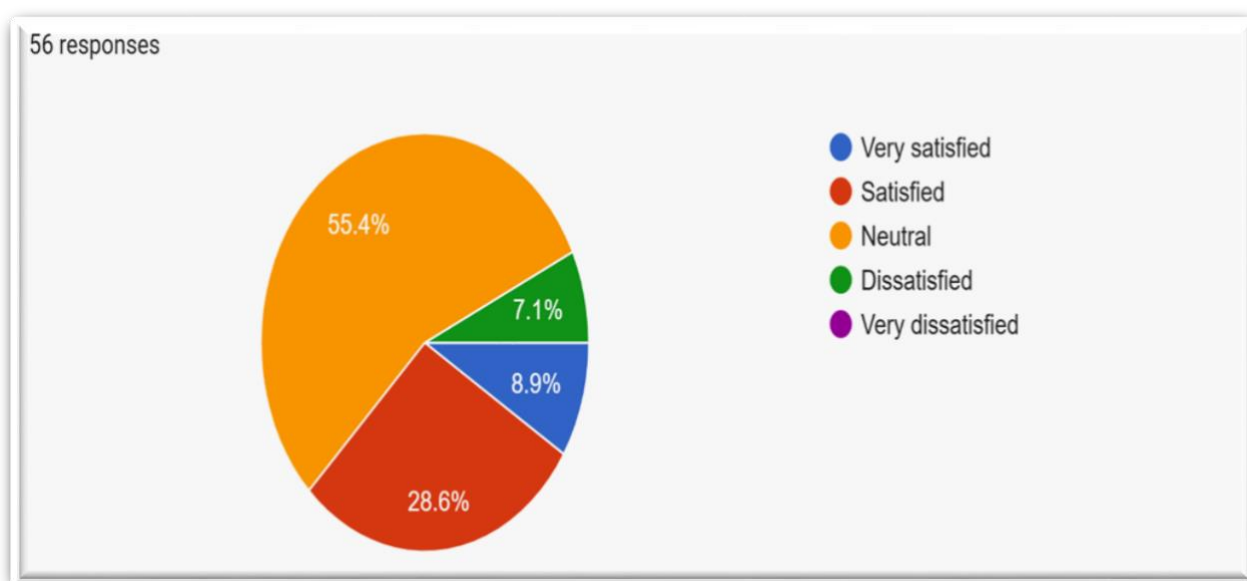


Interpretation:

The chart shows that out of 56 responses, 58.9% people have knowledge about tax returns, while 41.1% do not have knowledge.

17.Do you satisfied with your returns ?

RESPONSE	RESPONDENT	PERCENTAGE
Very Satisfied	8	8.9%
Satisfied	16	28.6%
Neutral	31	55.4%
Dissatisfied	4	7.1%
Very dissatisfied	NIL	NIL



Interpretation :

The majority of respondents (55.4%) are neutral about their investment returns, while 28.6% are dissatisfied. Only a small percentage (8.9%) reported being very satisfied, and 7.1% are satisfied. This indicates that most investors are neither fully satisfied nor highly dissatisfied, showing an overall average level of satisfaction with their returns.

Observations & Analysis



The survey data reveals that the majority of respondents are young adults, with 84.2% falling into the 15-20 age group and 15.8% in the 21-25 age group. No respondents were above 25 years old. Regarding the course of study, BAF is the most popular choice, accounting for 50.92% of respondents. BMS follows with 13.46%, while B.Com, Commerce, and Others each represent 11.54% of the respondents. This indicates a strong preference for BAF among the surveyed group, which primarily consists of individuals aged 15-25

First, a majority of the surveyed individuals (61.1% or 33 out of 54) do not have a family background in finance and business, suggesting a prevalence of individuals without such lineage in the group. Second, a significant portion of respondents (84.2% or 48 out of 57) are aware of the stock market, indicating a high level of general knowledge about this financial area, while only a small minority (15.8% or 9 out of 57) are not aware. This highlights a strong overall awareness of financial markets among the participants.

The study titled “Investment in Stock Market by College Students” provides a comprehensive understanding of how young investors, particularly students, perceive and participate in stock market activities. The findings of the research reveal that the majority of respondents belong to the 15–20 age group and are mainly from commerce-related courses such as BAF, BMS, and B.Com. This reflects that awareness and interest in financial markets are higher among students pursuing finance-oriented education.

A notable observation is that a large number of students (84.2%) are aware of the stock market, indicating a positive trend in financial literacy among youth. However, while awareness levels are high, most students (68.4%) identify themselves as beginners, which highlights a significant gap between awareness and actual financial expertise. The primary sources of stock market knowledge for students are social media and YouTube, followed by friends, family, and teachers. This demonstrates the increasing influence of digital media in shaping financial learning and investment behavior among the younger generation.

Another important observation from the field survey is that 61.4% of students have invested in the stock market, showing growing participation of young investors. However, the investment amounts are relatively small, with most students investing less than ₹1000. Mutual Funds (SIP) are the most preferred investment mode, chosen by 66% of respondents, while only a small percentage directly trade in stocks or derivatives. This suggests that students prefer safer and systematic investment options over high-risk trading.

The study also highlights the motivational factors behind student investments. The majority invest to gain knowledge and experience (35.7%) and to earn extra income (33.9%), while others view it as a means for long-term wealth creation. These responses indicate that young investors are not purely profit-driven but also view investing as an educational experience. Yet, uncertainty remains prevalent—42.1% of respondents are unsure whether they will increase their investments in the future, showing hesitation caused by risk and lack of proper guidance.

Out of 57 respondents, 35.1% expressed a clear intention to increase their investments in the stock market, while 22.8% stated they do not plan to invest further. A significant portion, 42.1%, remain uncertain and responded with “maybe.” This, that although there is considerable interest in expanding investments, many individuals are still hesitant and undecided, possibly due to factors such as risk perception, lack of knowledge, or market uncertainty.¹¹ Out of 57 respondents, a large majority (86%) believe that stock market education should be included as part of the college curriculum, while only 14% disagree. This shows strong support for integrating financial literacy and investment knowledge into academic studies, reflecting the growing awareness among students of the importance of practical financial education for future decision-making.

The majority of the data falls into the Medium category, making up over half (56.1%) of the total. The Low category is the second most common at 33.3%, while the High category is the least represented, accounting for only 10.5%. This suggests that most values are concentrated in

the medium range, with fewer instances of extreme highs. From the survey analysis of 57 respondents, it is evident that the primary source of income for investment is family support (36.8%), followed by pocket money (24.6%) and part-time jobs (21.1%). A smaller proportion rely on savings from scholarships (10.5%) and full-time jobs (7%). This indicates that most respondents are still financially dependent on external sources, particularly family, rather than their own earnings. The data suggests that for many individuals, investment activities are initiated with limited personal income, highlighting a dependency on support systems rather than financial independence.

Risk-taking ability among students is mostly moderate, with 56.1% rating themselves as medium risk-takers and 33.3% as low. Family support remains the primary source of income for investments (36.8%), followed by pocket money and part-time jobs. This reflects that most students are financially dependent and may lack the capital to make substantial investments.

In terms of financial expectations, most students expect returns of up to 10–20%, while a smaller number aim for higher returns. The major challenges faced include fear of loss (46.4%), lack of proper guidance (39.3%), and market volatility (39.3%). These concerns underline the need for financial education and mentorship to help students make informed decisions. Although 58.9% of respondents are aware of taxation on returns, many still lack comprehensive understanding of the practical aspects of investment regulations and taxation policies.

Satisfaction levels among student investors are generally neutral, with 55.4% expressing no strong opinion on their returns. This shows that most students are still in the early learning phase of investing and have yet to develop long-term confidence in their decisions. Encouragingly, 86% of respondents strongly believe that stock market education should be integrated into the college curriculum. This reflects growing awareness about the importance of financial literacy in shaping future economic behavior.

Overall, the observation from this study indicates that college students are showing increasing interest in the stock market, primarily for learning and experiential purposes rather than high-profit motives. However, the findings also reveal significant gaps in professional knowledge, investment planning, and risk management. Providing structured education, workshops, and practical training in financial markets could empower students to become more responsible and confident investors. This research successfully highlights the transition of youth from passive financial observers to active participants in the investment ecosystems.

Chapter V

Conclusion & Recommendations



The study “Investment in Stock Market by College Students” was undertaken to understand how young individuals, particularly college students, perceive and participate in the stock market. It explored their awareness, motivation, risk appetite, investment patterns, and the factors influencing their decisions. Based on the analysis and interpretations derived from both primary and secondary data, several key conclusions can be drawn.

Firstly, the research reveals that a large proportion of college students are aware of the stock market and its functioning. Around 84% of respondents reported having some knowledge about it, which shows that financial awareness among youth is increasing compared to earlier decades. However, the depth of this knowledge remains limited — nearly 68% of the respondents considered themselves beginners, suggesting that while awareness exists, conceptual understanding and analytical skills are still developing. This highlights the need for formal financial education within academic institutions.

Secondly, the findings indicate that social media and online platforms play a significant role in shaping students’ investment awareness. Over 59% of students stated that their main source of knowledge about stock markets comes from social media and YouTube, followed by family, friends, and teachers. This demonstrates how the digital environment has replaced traditional sources of financial information such as newspapers and business journals. However, this also brings challenges, as not all online information is reliable or well-researched. Hence, the role of verified educational resources becomes vital to prevent misinformation and impulsive decision-making.

Another important conclusion is that a majority of students (61%) have invested in the stock market at least once, showing a promising trend of youth participation in financial markets. The preferred investment mode among them is Mutual Funds (SIP), chosen by 66% of respondents. This choice reflects a cautious and systematic approach to investment, as SIPs are less risky and

easier to manage than direct equity or derivatives. Only a small portion of respondents invested in direct stocks, indicating that students prefer safer and more guided investment avenues.

The study also reveals that most students invest small amounts, usually below ₹1,000 to ₹5,000, mainly due to limited financial resources. Their primary sources of funds are family support, pocket money, or part-time jobs. This suggests that while enthusiasm for investment is growing, students are still financially dependent and unable to invest significant amounts. Nonetheless, this early exposure to investing habits can create a foundation for more responsible and informed investment behavior in adulthood.

In terms of motivation, students invest mainly to gain knowledge and experience (35.7%), followed closely by the desire to earn extra income (33.9%) and long-term wealth creation (29.8%). This mix of educational and financial motives shows that college students view investing as both a learning opportunity and a means of financial empowerment. However, the majority of students (56%) have a medium risk-taking ability, reflecting a balanced attitude — neither too conservative nor overly aggressive. This moderate approach indicates awareness of potential risks but also a willingness to explore opportunities.

The research also identifies major challenges faced by young investors. The most significant barriers include fear of loss (46.4%), lack of proper guidance (39.3%), and market volatility (39.3%). These findings underline the necessity for better financial education and mentorship programs that can guide students through market complexities. Furthermore, although many respondents have some understanding of taxation on investment returns (58.9%), there is still a considerable portion lacking clarity on this aspect, which may affect their overall financial planning.

An encouraging result is that 86% of students believe stock market education should be part of the college curriculum. This strong consensus demonstrates that students recognize the value of practical financial knowledge. Incorporating financial literacy and investment studies in higher education can empower future generations to make informed financial decisions, promote saving habits, and reduce dependence on unverified external advice.

Finally, the overall satisfaction level with investment returns was moderate. More than half of the respondents remained neutral about their returns, suggesting that their investment expectations are realistic but outcomes are still limited by inexperience and small capital size.

Despite this, a considerable number of students expressed their intention to increase investments in the future, reflecting optimism and growing confidence in financial markets.

Chapter V

References



Title	Authors / Journal	What's covered
A Study of Students Stock Market Participation and Awareness	Devansh Priye & Sumit Sangwan; Journal of Scientific Research and Technology (2023)	How informed college students are, how much they participate in stock markets, awareness levels etc.
Stock Market Participation Awareness among University Students in Nepal	Anil Kumar Lama, Gyanendra Karki, Sangam Neupane; NPRC Journal of Multidisciplinary Research	Survey of Nepalese university students; factors affecting participation, awareness.
A Study On Investment Trends And Behavioral Patterns Of College Students In The Stock Market	P.S. Suganya, T. Sreegeetha, R. Raghul etc.; IJCRT	Looks at how students invest, what influences them (risk, peer influence, digital info etc.)
A Study on Stock Market Awareness among College and University Students in Ballari	Srikantnaik H, Jayanth H; IJFANS	Measures awareness, knowledge about stock market among undergrads; examines factors like academic discipline, parental wealth etc.

Books

Here are some books that are good for understanding stock markets, investing behavior, and can help you with theory/case studies:

- * The Intelligent Investor by Benjamin Graham — classic on value investing, risk-management, mental aspects.
- * A Random Walk Down Wall Street by Burton G. Malkiel — efficient market hypothesis, long-term investing insight.
- * Stock Investing for Dummies by Paul Mladjenovic — beginner friendly, practical basics.
- * Stock Investing Mastermind Beginners Handbook to Winning the Stock Market (ZebraLearn) — tailored for beginners, Indian market reference.

Websites

SHS Conferences (PDF)

https://digitalcommons.conncoll.edu/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=1045&context=econhp&utm_source=chatgpt.com

WeForum / World Economic Forum

https://www.weforum.org/stories/2024/05/globally-young-people-are-investing-more-than-ever-but-do-they-have-the-best-tools-to-do-so/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

International Journal / IJSART

https://ijsart.com/public/storage/paper/pdf/IJSART113102743.pdf?utm_source=chatgpt.com

Survey google form :-

<https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSfMHP0-TRkfvrHiFBRfX4TCy1GGIZDr71Np1zxD8tAj8P6FaA/viewform?usp=header>

Chapter VII

Appendices



Questionnaires

Study of Investment in Stock Market by college students in dombivli area Field project for the SIA college

1. Name
2. Age
 - i. 15-20
 - ii. 21-25
 - iii. 26-30
 - iv. Above 30
3. Course of Study
4. Do you have any family background in finance and business ?
 - i. Yes
 - ii. No
5. Are you aware of the stock market ?
 - i. Yes
 - ii. No
6. What is your main source of stock market knowledge ?
 - i. Family/Friends
 - ii. College/Teachers
 - iii. Social media/Youtube
 - iv. Other
7. How would you rate your level of knowledge about stock market investment ?
 - i. Beginner
 - ii. Intermediate
 - iii. Advanced
8. Have you ever invested in the stock market ?
 - i. Yes
 - ii. No

9. At what age did you first hear about stock market ?
10. How much (on avg) do you invest in the market ?
- i. Less than 1000
 - ii. 1000 - 5000
 - iii. 5000 – 10000
 - iv. Above 10000
 - v. Not Applicable
11. What mode of investment do you use ?
- i. Direct Stock
 - ii. Mutual Funds (SIP)
 - iii. Derivatives
 - iv. Other
12. What motivates you to invest in the stock market ?
- i. To earn extra income
 - ii. To gain knowledge / experience
 - iii. Long wealth creation
 - iv. Other
13. Do you plan to increase your investment in the stock market ?
- i. Yes
 - ii. No
 - iii. May Be
14. Do you think stock market education should be part of college curriculum (syllabus, studies, subjects) ?
- i. Yes
 - ii. No
15. How do you consider your risk taking ability ?
- i. Low
 - ii. Medium
 - iii. High

16. What is your source of income for investment ?

- i. Family Support
- ii. Part time job
- iii. Savings from scholarships
- iv. Pocket money
- v. Full time job

17. How much return do you expect from stock market ?

- i. Less than 10%
- ii. 10% - 20%
- iii. 20% - 30%
- iv. Above 30%

18. What challenges you face while investing ?

- i. Fear of loss
- ii. No proper guidance
- iii. Market volatility
- iv. Other

19. Do you have knowledge about tax on returns ?

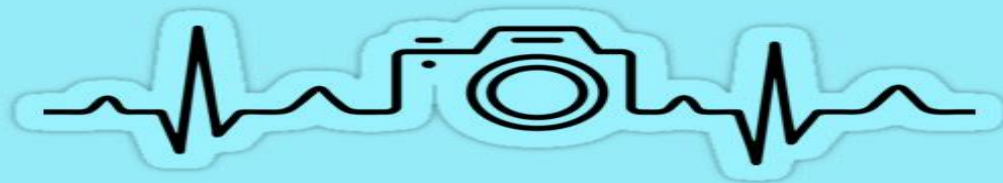
- i. Yes
- ii. No

20. Do you satisfied with your returns ?

- i. Very satisfied
- ii. Satisfied
- iii. Neutral
- iv. Dissatisfied
- v. Very dissatisfied

Chapter VIII

Survey Photographs





Dombivli, Maharashtra, India 🇮🇳
 Pendharkar College, K.v, Kalyan Rd, Azde Gaon, Tata Power
 Company Limited, Dombivli, Maharashtra 421203, India
 Lat 19.213854° Long 73.105138°
 27/09/2025 12:17 PM GMT +05:30



Dombivli, Maharashtra, India 🇮🇳
 Shop No:-2,yadnya Heights, Gymkhana Rd, Opp. Sia
 College, Sagarli Gaon, Dombivli, Maharashtra 421203, India
 Lat 19.20907° Long 73.099658°
 30/09/2025 11:16 AM GMT +05:30



Dombivli, Maharashtra, India 🇮🇳
 Shop No:-2,yadnya Heights, Gymkhana Rd, Opp. Sia
 College, Sagarli Gaon, Dombivli, Maharashtra 421203, India
 Lat 19.208938° Long 73.099533°
 30/09/2025 11:14 AM GMT +05:30



Thane, Maharashtra, India 🇮🇳
 635x+gqm ltm-sia Business School, Gymkhana Rd, Azde Gaon,
 Sagarli Gaon, Dombivli East, Thane, Maharashtra 421203, India





Annexure

Student Feedback on FP

(To be filled by students after FP completion)

- **Student Name:** Bhuvaneshwari Samy Durai
- **Roll No:** FF124023
- **Department:** SYBAF
- **Name of Mentor:** Mr. Mukul Kulkarni
- **Title of Field Project:** Study Of Investment In Stock Market By Collage Students
- **Brief description of FP carried out:**

- **Date of FP:**

- **Was your internship experience related to your major area of study?**

- **Indicate the degree to which you agree or disagree with the following statement**

This experience has	Strongly Agree	Agree	No opinion	Disagree	Strongly Disagree
Given me the opportunity to explore a career field					

Allowed me to apply classroom theory to practice					
Helped me develop my decision-making and problem-solving skills					
Expanded my knowledge about the work world before permanent employment Helped me develop my written and oral communication skills					
Provided a chance to use leadership skills (influence others, develop ideas with others, stimulate decision-making and action)					
Expanded my sensitivity to the ethical implications of the work involved					
Made it possible for me to be more confident in new situations Given me a chance to improve my interpersonal skills					
Helped me learn to handle responsibility and use my time wisely					
Helped me discover new aspects of myself that I didn't know existed before					
Helped me develop new interests and abilities					
Helped me clarify my career goals					
Allowed me to acquire information and/ or use equipment not available at my Institute					

Allowed me to realize socio-economic issues in the society					
--	--	--	--	--	--

- In the Institute FP program, faculty members are expected to be mentors for students. Do you feel that your faculty mentor served such a function? Why or why not?
- How well were you able to accomplish the initial goals, tasks and new skills that were set down in your learning contract? In what ways were you able to take a new direction or expand beyond your contract? Why were some goals not accomplished adequately?
- In what areas did you most develop and improve?
- What has been the most significant accomplishment or satisfying moment of your FP?
- What did you dislike about the FP?
- Considering your overall experience, how would you rate this FP? (Circle one). –
Satisfactory/ Good/ Excellent

- Give suggestions as to how your FP experience could have been improved. (Could you have handled added responsibility? Would you have liked more discussions with your professor concerning your FP? Was closer supervision needed? Was more of an orientation required?)

Signature of Student

Name: Bhuvaneshwari Samy Durai

Date:

Annexure

Student Feedback on FP

(To be filled by students after FP completion)

- **Student Name:** Janhvi Santosh Gade
- **Roll No:** FF124024
- **Department:** SYBAF
- **Name of Mentor:** Mr. Mukul Kulkarni
- **Title of Field Project:** Study Of Investment In Stock Market By Collage Students
- **Brief description of FP carried out:**

- **Date of FP:**
- **Was your internship experience related to your major area of study?**

- **Indicate the degree to which you agree or disagree with the following statement**

This experience has	Strongly Agree	Agree	No opinion	Disagree	Strongly Disagree
Given me the opportunity to explore a career field					

Allowed me to apply classroom theory to practice					
Helped me develop my decision-making and problem-solving skills					
Expanded my knowledge about the work world before permanent employment Helped me develop my written and oral communication skills					
Provided a chance to use leadership skills (influence others, develop ideas with others, stimulate decision-making and action)					
Expanded my sensitivity to the ethical implications of the work involved					
Made it possible for me to be more confident in new situations Given me a chance to improve my interpersonal skills					
Helped me learn to handle responsibility and use my time wisely					
Helped me discover new aspects of myself that I didn't know existed before					
Helped me develop new interests and abilities					
Helped me clarify my career goals					

Allowed me to acquire information and/ or use equipment not available at my Institute					
Allowed me to realize socio-economic issues in the society					

- In the Institute FP program, faculty members are expected to be mentors for students. Do you feel that your faculty mentor served such a function? Why or why not?

- How well were you able to accomplish the initial goals, tasks and new skills that were set down in your learning contract? In what ways were you able to take a new direction or expand beyond your contract? Why were some goals not accomplished adequately?

- In what areas did you most develop and improve?

- What has been the most significant accomplishment or satisfying moment of your FP?

- What did you dislike about the FP?

- Considering your overall experience, how would you rate this FP? (Circle one). –
Satisfactory/ Good/ Excellent

- Give suggestions as to how your FP experience could have been improved. (Could you have handled added responsibility? Would you have liked more discussions with your professor concerning your FP? Was closer supervision needed? Was more of an orientation required?)

Signature of Student

Name: Janhvi Santosh Gade

Date:

Annexure

Student Feedback on FP

(To be filled by students after FP completion)

- **Student Name:** Vaishnavi Jagan Gade
- **Roll No:** FF124025
- **Department:** SYBAF
- **Name of Mentor:** Mr. Mukul Kulkarni
- **Title of Field Project:** Study Of Investment In Stock Market By Collage Students
- **Brief description of FP carried out:**

- **Date of FP:**
- **Was your internship experience related to your major area of study?**

- **Indicate the degree to which you agree or disagree with the following statement**

This experience has	Strongly Agree	Agree	No opinion	Disagree	Strongly Disagree
Given me the opportunity to explore a career field					

Allowed me to apply classroom theory to practice					
Helped me develop my decision-making and problem-solving skills					
Expanded my knowledge about the work world before permanent employment Helped me develop my written and oral communication skills					
Provided a chance to use leadership skills (influence others, develop ideas with others, stimulate decision-making and action)					
Expanded my sensitivity to the ethical implications of the work involved					
Made it possible for me to be more confident in new situations Given me a chance to improve my interpersonal skills					
Helped me learn to handle responsibility and use my time wisely					
Helped me discover new aspects of myself that I didn't know existed before					
Helped me develop new interests and abilities					
Helped me clarify my career goals					

Allowed me to acquire information and/ or use equipment not available at my Institute					
Allowed me to realize socio-economic issues in the society					

- In the Institute FP program, faculty members are expected to be mentors for students. Do you feel that your faculty mentor served such a function? Why or why not?

- How well were you able to accomplish the initial goals, tasks and new skills that were set down in your learning contract? In what ways were you able to take a new direction or expand beyond your contract? Why were some goals not accomplished adequately?

- In what areas did you most develop and improve?

- What has been the most significant accomplishment or satisfying moment of your FP?

- What did you dislike about the FP?

- Considering your overall experience, how would you rate this FP? (Circle one). –
Satisfactory/ Good/ Excellent

- Give suggestions as to how your FP experience could have been improved. (Could you have handled added responsibility? Would you have liked more discussions with your professor concerning your FP? Was closer supervision needed? Was more of an orientation required?)

Signature of Student

Name: Vaishnavi Jagan Gade

Date:

Annexure

Student Feedback on FP

(To be filled by students after FP completion)

- **Student Name:** Chaitanya Sharad Gaonkar
- **Roll No:** FF124026
- **Department:** SYBAF
- **Name of Mentor:** Mr. Mukul Kulkarni
- **Title of Field Project:** Study Of Investment In Stock Market By Collage Students
- **Brief description of FP carried out:** The field project titled “Study of Investment in Stock Market by College Students” aims to analyse the awareness, perception, and investment behaviours of college students toward the stock market. The study focuses on understanding how students manage their savings, their level of financial literacy, and the factors influencing their investment decisions. Data was collected through surveys and questionnaires to assess their knowledge, risk appetite, and preferred investment avenues. The project helps in identifying the need for financial education and encourages young investors to participate in capital markets responsibly.
- **Date of FP:**
- **Was your internship experience related to your major area of study?**
- **Indicate the degree to which you agree or disagree with the following statement**

This experience has	Strongly Agree	Agree	No opinion	Disagree	Strongly Disagree
---------------------	----------------	-------	------------	----------	-------------------

Given me the opportunity to explore a career field		✓			
Allowed me to apply classroom theory to practice		✓			
Helped me develop my decision-making and problem-solving skills		✓			
Expanded my knowledge about the work world before permanent employment Helped me develop my written and oral communication skills	✓				
Provided a chance to use leadership skills (influence others, develop ideas with others, stimulate decision-making and action)	✓				
Expanded my sensitivity to the ethical implications of the work involved			✓		
Made it possible for me to be more confident in new situations Given me a chance to improve my interpersonal skills	✓				
Helped me learn to handle responsibility and use my time wisely	✓				
Helped me discover new aspects of myself that I didn't know existed before		✓			
Helped me develop new interests and abilities	✓				
Helped me clarify my career goals	✓				

Allowed me to acquire information and/ or use equipment not available at my Institute		✓			
Allowed me to realize socio-economic issues in the society			✓		

- In the Institute FP program, faculty members are expected to be mentors for students. Do you feel that your faculty mentor served such a function? Why or why not?

- How well were you able to accomplish the initial goals, tasks and new skills that were set down in your learning contract? In what ways were you able to take a new direction or expand beyond your contract? Why were some goals not accomplished adequately?

- In what areas did you most develop and improve?

- What has been the most significant accomplishment or satisfying moment of your FP?

- What did you dislike about the FP?

- Considering your overall experience, how would you rate this FP? (Circle one). –
Satisfactory/ Good/ Excellent

- Give suggestions as to how your FP experience could have been improved. (Could you have handled added responsibility? Would you have liked more discussions with your professor concerning your FP? Was closer supervision needed? Was more of an orientation required?)

Signature of Student

Name: Chaitanya Sharad Gaonkar

Date:

Annexure

Student Feedback on FP

(To be filled by students after FP completion)

- **Student Name:** Disha Pradeep Gaonkar
- **Roll No:** FF124027
- **Department:** SYBAF
- **Name of Mentor:** Mr. Mukul Kulkarni
- **Title of Field Project:** Study Of Investment In Stock Market By Collage Students
- **Brief description of FP carried out:** The project “Study of Investment in Stock Market by College Students” aimed to understand students’ awareness and interest in stock market investments. Data was collected through a questionnaire to analyze their investment habits, knowledge levels, and factors influencing their decisions. The study highlighted the need for greater financial literacy among college students.
- **Date of FP:**
- **Was your internship experience related to your major area of study?**
- **Indicate the degree to which you agree or disagree with the following statement**

This experience has	Strongly Agree	Agree	No opinion	Disagree	Strongly Disagree
Given me the opportunity to explore a career field	✓				

Allowed me to apply classroom theory to practice		✓			
Helped me develop my decision-making and problem-solving skills		✓			
Expanded my knowledge about the work world before permanent employment Helped me develop my written and oral communication skills	✓				
Provided a chance to use leadership skills (influence others, develop ideas with others, stimulate decision-making and action)	✓				
Expanded my sensitivity to the ethical implications of the work involved		✓			
Made it possible for me to be more confident in new situations Given me a chance to improve my interpersonal skills		✓			
Helped me learn to handle responsibility and use my time wisely	✓				
Helped me discover new aspects of myself that I didn't know existed before		✓			
Helped me develop new interests and abilities			✓		
Helped me clarify my career goals		✓			

Allowed me to acquire information and/ or use equipment not available at my Institute		✓			
Allowed me to realize socio-economic issues in the society			✓		

- In the Institute FP program, faculty members are expected to be mentors for students. Do you feel that your faculty mentor served such a function? Why or why not?

- How well were you able to accomplish the initial goals, tasks and new skills that were set down in your learning contract? In what ways were you able to take a new direction or expand beyond your contract? Why were some goals not accomplished adequately?

- In what areas did you most develop and improve?

- What has been the most significant accomplishment or satisfying moment of your FP?

- What did you dislike about the FP?

- Considering your overall experience, how would you rate this FP? (Circle one). –
Satisfactory/ Good/ Excellent

- Give suggestions as to how your FP experience could have been improved. (Could you have handled added responsibility? Would you have liked more discussions with your professor concerning your FP? Was closer supervision needed? Was more of an orientation required?)

Signature of Student

Name: Disha Pradeep Gaonkar

Date: